

MEQ PRACTICE QUESTIONS (CASE STUDIES)

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 18

You are a junior consultant psychiatrist working in a regional area. There has been an electroconvulsive therapy (ECT) adverse event (critical incident) involving ECT for a patient.

- a) **A First-year student asks you to explain what a root cause analysis is. List/explain/describe (8 marks)**
- b) **You are asked to prepare a teaching session for stage 2 trainees on the background, prescription and administration of ECT. Outline what you would cover? (14 marks)**

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 19

Joe, a 45-year-old gentleman with schizophrenia working as a gardener has recently relocated from another service. You have access to his previous information.

He is able to make decisions for himself. He is stable on Clozapine 400mg daily for the last 15 years. The new case manager tells you the handover from previous community mental health team has been adequate and all relevant documents have been sent across.

Joe wants to change his anti-psychotic medication because he is struggling with side effects of tiredness, sleeping 12 hours a day, his head feels foggy and he can only work two days a week (as a gardener) due to these symptoms. He is compliant with medications but on the odd occasion that he forgets his clozapine, he feels brighter.

- a) **What information would you like to find out before you consider Joe's request for medication change?**
- b) **You decide to go ahead and change Joe's antipsychotic, what strategies can you use to safely transition him from clozapine to another antipsychotic?**
- c) **A medical student asks you to explain what the withdrawal and discontinuation syndromes one might experience from stopping an antipsychotic. How would you answer this question? (4 marks)**

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 20

42-year-old married Indonesian woman, lives with husband and their 3-year-old child. She presented following an overdose of 10 tablets of 10mg amitriptyline. She felt hopeless that her physical health will not return to normal functioning.

When you saw her, she was adamant that she was no longer suicidal. She feels depressed, tired, lethargic, predominantly somatically focussed and not able to work as a tutor at university.

Her husband is *not happy* that she is not doing any work or looking after her son and this has caused conflict in their relationship.

You see her in post overdose clinic.

Husband tells you that he is not happy for her to be followed up by a psychiatrist.

a) List and explain possible causes of stigma in this situation.

GP has thoroughly examined and completed investigation and there's no identifiable cause to explain her somatic symptoms and thinks she is depressed.

b) List and explain possible differential diagnosis

c) Your consultant asks you what are the things that you will want to do before closing her case OR

List and justify the issues around non-engagement that you would discuss with your supervisor / Exploration of factors impacting psychotherapy

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 21

Young male believes he has ADHD.

- a) **Approach to assessment**
- b) **What are the Issues in prescribing medication in Adult ADHD.**
- c) **Your prescribing in Adult ADHD is higher than your peers in the region. How would you respond and manage? Your clinical director hands you an evaluation showing that your practice was prescribing psychostimulants vastly different to those of your peers. How would you go about addressing this?**
- d) **Non-pharmacological strategies in management of Adult ADHD.**